

Ailani Sato-Lim

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website (WIP): ailanisl.github.io/academics/

Education

University of California, Berkeley, *magna cum laude* (GPA: 3.977) 2021-2025
B.A., Cognitive Science (Highest Honors)
Minor in Buddhist Studies

Fellowships and Awards

Robert J. Glushko Prize for Distinguished Undergraduate Research, UC Berkeley (\$750) 2025
Phi Beta Kappa, Alpha of California 2025
UC Berkeley Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship (\$5,000) 2024
Khyentse Foundation Award for Academic Excellence in Buddhist Studies (\$1,500) 2024
Dean's List, UC Berkeley College of Letters and Sciences 2022-2023

Conference Presentations

Sato-Lim, A. (2025 August). "Intellectual Nets and the Fish of Delusion: Metaphors of Buddhist Modernism." **Poster presentation**, 17th Annual Researching and Applying Metaphor Conference at Lawrence Technological University, Springfield, MI.
Sato-Lim, A. (2024 August). "Unfolding the Mind: How Conceptual Metaphors for Self Shape American Buddhism." **Oral presentation**, Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship Conference at the University of California, Berkeley.

Research Experience

Honors Thesis "Intellectual Nets and the Fish of Delusion: Metaphors of Buddhist Modernism"

Advisors: Dr. Eve Sweetser, Dr. Robert Sharf Fall 2024 - Spring 2025

- Corpus analysis of Buddhist modernist texts regarding metaphors of mind and time. I traced the sensorimotor entailments such metaphors held in shaping Western conception of Buddhist thought and practice. This project contributed to the understanding of how metaphor reflects and reshapes doctrinal and experiential dimensions of religion, especially in cross-cultural and modernizing contexts.

Research Assistant for the MetaNet Project (University of British Columbia) Spring 2024, Present

Mentor: Dr. Eve Sweetser, Dr. Elise Stickles

- Systematically identified and analyzed metaphors on climate change and COVID-19 from large-scale text corpora.
- Performed literature reviews to identify new metaphoric framings.

- Collected textual data from far-right media and online discussion forums; qualitatively coded linguistic metaphors based on religious source frames (e.g., altar, cult, saints, gospel, etc.).

Research Assistant at Language and Cognitive Development Lab (UC Berkeley) Spring 2023 - Spring 2024

PI: Mahesh Srinivasan; Mentor: Sophie Reagan

Children's Understanding of the Connection Between Language and Social Cues

- Contributed to the study design and creation of test stimuli; collected data through in-person testing of participants ages 4-6 at local museums and libraries.
- Organized surveys with Qualtrics; performed data entry, coding, and analysis of audiovisual data on Sharepoint and Excel.
- Presented preliminary results and further directions at department meeting.

Research Assistant, Developing Belief Network (UC Berkeley | UC Santa Cruz) Spring 2023

PIs: Mahesh Srinivasan, Audun Dahl

Coded data of audio files on Box.

Work Experience

Initial Director and Project Manager for Platform Justice, 501(c)(3) nonprofit July 2025 - Present

- *Project management*: structured internal knowledge system, created detailed and automated framework to organize our meetings, notes, and project pipelines.
- *Design*: visual branding, frontend website development.
- *Grantwriting*: crafting, formatting & organizing application materials for nonprofit seed grants & fellowships.

Barista at RareTea Berkeley 2021 - 2025

Skills

Programming & Script	Python, SQL, R, HTML/CSS, JavaScript
Python Packages	pandas, NumPy, matplotlib
Tools	Qualtrics, Jupyter Notebook, Git, Adobe Photoshop, Figma
Languages	Japanese (native), Spanish (Basic)

Selected Coursework

- Foundations of Data Science [[textbook](#)] (A)
- Computational Structures of Data Science [[textbook](#)] (A+)
- Computational Modeling of Cognition (A+)
- Language and Thought (A+)
- Intro to Linguistic Science (A+)
- Brain, Mind, Behavior (A)
- Perception (A)